"MOUNTAINSIDE ECHO"

A NEWSLETTER PUBLISHED OCCASIONALLY

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ANNUAL MEETING OF MOUNTAINSIDE ASSOCIATION

On November 6th, the Coolfont Mountainside Association will have its annual meeting in Treetop House. Materials for the meeting will be sent later, but please be sure to mark your fall calendar for this important event, starting at 1 p.m.

BYLAWS COMMITTEE ESTABLISHED

As a result of a recent search through musty files, a copy of the Bylaws of the Mountainside Association was unearthed. It was found that the bylaws were impractical in many respects and a small committee (John Yates and George Fiske) is busy rewriting the Bylaws for your consideration at the Annual Meeting

CONTRIBUTIONS SOLICITED FOR FOUNDATION PROGRAMS

Members are urged to make a tax deductible contribution to Coolfont Foundation to help with costs of programs. Thirty-five dollars will make you a sponsor for the year. Please mail to Foundation, Coolfont, Berkeley Springs, W. Va. 25411

AD HOC TRAIL COMMITTEE HAS SUCCESSFUL DAY IN WOODS

An enthusiastic band of Mountainsiders headed by Nick Bedessem and focused by Ivan Asay braved the perils of the woods in April to improve some of our trails. The blue trail was cleared and blazed with blue paint. A new trail (red-orange) was established running from the barn to the road near the G section.

COOLFONT MOUNTAINSIDE ASSOCIATION BECAME PROUD OWNERS OF THE SEWER SYSTEM

We now own and maintain the sewer system throughout Coolfont. We also collect income from each house ($40 per year) which in the past has more than covered the cost of maintenance of the system. The actual tasks of maintenance will be carried out by Mr. Cain and his helpers.

NEW TENNIS COURTS OPPOSED BY 20% OF MEMBERS

The recent poll regarding the proposal for the Development Company to build additional tennis courts, etc., showed out of 77 potential votes 20 votes negative and 29 votes positive. This negative vote just exceeded the 25% established by the Board of Directors, to authorize immediate construction. As it was impossible to call a membership meeting in time to have construction completed for summer, it was felt best to defer consideration until the fall meeting.

The Board voted unanimously to continue the existing tennis courts relationship with Re+Creation for this summer.

ARCHITECTURAL CONTROL COMMITTEE BUSY ON REVISED GUIDELINES

Realizing a need to more precisely spell out architectural guidelines, the Committee has been busy at work and will present its report to the Board on June 19.

NO SLOW BUMPS AT COOLFONT. SIGNS TO GO UP INSTEAD.

In an attempt to control speeding on our roads, the Board considered slow bump installation. But this would seriously interfere with snow plowing. So in the near future we will be installing a few signs designed to attract the attention of motorists.

ROADS TO BE RESURFACED

By the time this reaches you, we hopefully will have a newly resurfaced roadway through our Mountainside Association property.

NAMES FOR COOLFONT ROADS NEEDED

Please send suggestions for names for roads at Coolfont to Roland Szadokierski, 7207 Fort Hunt Road, Alexandria, Va. 22307. This is needed by June 15 in order for the Board to act on June 19. Please Help -- Last Chance!

YOUR SUGGESTIONS FOR IMPROVEMENTS AT COOLFONT SOLICITED

The Board of Directors wishes to have your suggestions for improvements at Coolfont. We have a group of hardworking committees able to handle problems and to act in a constructive manner on behalf of the membership. So send any suggestions you may have to John Yates, 8602 Irvington Avenue, Bethesda, Md. 20234. Also please be prepared to serve on committees to help make Coolfont an even better place to live and play.

MEMO FROM SAM ASHELMAN...

Dear Mountainside Members,

I want to tell you about a number of new things which have been happening or been done here at Coolfont this past winter and let you in on some of the plans for the summer.

First of all, our new management team consists of Dave Adams, Todd Capen, Steve Smith, Beth Peters and Bob Donadieu. They have been very busy and working hard to get ready for a busy summer while improving facilities, service, and sales. We have increased the sandy beach size by fifty percent, changed our method of control so we can keep people off the beach who are not guests. Because of the small amount of rain this past spring, we were able to lower the lake and do a better job of cleaning out leaves and eliminating most of the weeds. We have, also, rebuilt our kitchen and added new equipment to take care of the increased business. The last five months over last year we had a 100 per cent increase in our food volume, reflecting the excellent job being done by our people. We have also redecorated the dining room, put in new carpeting and built a new salad bar which is bringing raves. We have employed a conference salesman who has been busy talking to many potential contacts for conferences this coming year. Our home rental program is beginning to work. We had an increase of 50% during the last 5 months. We have also enlarged our conference facilities, added three new conference rooms, and enlarged another one so we can now accommodate two groups of 50 or more each.

For the summer, our management have planned a number of things. First of all we are bringing Pat Shields back to do hootennanies on Friday evenings; Saturdays we plan square dances at the barn which will be used during the daytime as a part of the arts and crafts program. We also have developed a new youth program, giving special attention to young people. I urge those with active families to attend the meeting June 19th at the Sexton's house here.

At Treetop House, we have some wonderful folksingers, Sam and Joe who do hammered dulcimer and fiddle playing every Sunday. In the evenings, on the weekends, we also have some young people with marvelous voices singing and playing the guitar. Coolfont Foundation has a number of chamber music and other interesting programs planned. However, we are still in need of some artists who will come accepting our hospitality as compensation. We still don't have unlimited funds to spend on good music programs. We like to have your suggestions and help in this matter. Several of our people have volunteered their homes for artists who are here for weekend hospitality. This is very helpful. We could probably still use a few more. Construction of new houses continues to accelerate. We now have six houses under construction, bringing our grand total to 36. I had hoped that we would

have completed for the summer several new tennis courts, a basketball-volleyball court. However, due I think largely to my fault, there was some misunderstanding about why I proposed locating the courts on the Mountainside land. When the results came in of the vote, 26 percent of the lots eligible to vote either had questions or were opposed to having the courts located there. The Board decided even though this was minority of our members, it would be better to wait until later to discuss this matter so we could come, we would hope, to a greater unanimity of opinion regarding the courts. I will get to you later a more complete statement as to why it seemed like a good idea to me to locate the courts there. However, I should point out that in order to sell lots, it is necessary for a Developer to put in more courts than needed until houses are built. I had planned that the use by Re+Creation guests would gradually fade away. The members' Recreation Committee has approved the concept of one court for each 25 houses or part thereof -- for example, when Mountainside had 51 houses, three courts would be used exclusively by members. Also, that the maintenance expense would be paid by Re+Creation in proportion to use. It should be clear that without cooperation between Re+Creation and Mountainside members and if they were completely separate and independent, it would cost members a lot more and that now, members do not pay for the programs or improvements, like increasing the size of the beach.

I am happy to report that the state has agreed to dig out the curve directly across from Treetop House. This should make the road somewhat safer.

More and more people are finding Coolfont. Factors like better roads, pressures from the city are beyond our control. These however combined with a better facility, better management, and help from our members are making us more economically viable and able to support still better quality. However, as we grow we realize there are many things which need to be done.

I am still "in love" with Coolfont and will continue to try and keep it beautiful and a quiet sanctuary conducive to growth and enjoyment of individuals and families.

We need the close and understanding cooperation of members with the Re+Creation staff to maintain and improve the advantages of the total project. One without the other would be an empty shell.

Enclosed are the pass cards for you and your family. Please be sure to bring them with you